

OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE

FIFTY-SIXTH YEAR. No. 16.

OREGON CITY, OREGON, FRIDAY, APRIL 21, 1922.

ESTABLISHED 1866

COMPROMISE ON CITY HALL SITE NEARING ROCKS

Singer Hill Location Facing Stormy Action at Council Meeting Tonight; Proposal Getting Scant Approval.

ARCHITECTS ARE TO INVESTIGATE PLANS

Joint Measure On Ballot Now Forecasted; Recall Not to Be Considered at Present.

The Singer Hill compromise site for the city hall in all probability will neither be placed on the ballot nor approved by the city council. Indications to this effect loomed yesterday when it was found that a number of members of the council do not favor the building of the hall on the bluff site near the 7th street steps, and it is more than probable that the project will meet a deadlock when it is presented to the city fathers at their special session this evening.

Committee Meets
The Singer Hill location was originally proposed as a compromise between the hill and town sections. A committee appointed at the joint meeting yesterday viewed the site, and in accordance with their instructions will make recommendations to the council this evening. Just what form these recommendations will take has not been disclosed though it is understood that a definite agreement has been reached.

The number of councilmen who have expressed themselves as against the Singer Hill site is not as yet sufficient to permanently block the measure even if an attempt is made to force it through but it is practically certain that the battle which would ensue over the attempt to build the city hall on the old mill site would be such that the council would not feel justified in taking action itself and would submit the proposition to the voters.

Ballot Is Talked
Probable action by the various committees which are interested in the location of the city hall, indicates that if any measures are placed on the May ballot, the two, providing for a hill location on the Canfield property or the use of the old city hall on Main street will be the only two considered. Any movement to recall the bonds, as a retaliatory measure, cannot be made until the November election unless a special ballot is called. Definite action on the Singer Hill location is expected to be further delayed by the need for an expert opinion as to the possibility of using it as a building site. It is probable that an engineer and architect will be employed to investigate the proposition from this angle.

The rocky path outlined for the compromise position will probably never be tread as a stormy session over the matter is booked to commence in the council chambers tonight.

The Singer mill site for the city hall is to be investigated and reported on by the city council. This was decided last night at a special session of the civic body.

A petition which had been framed as the composite work of the representatives from the hill and the town section was read by the recorder and discussed at some length by the council and various individuals. It asked that the council investigate the Singer hill site and if feasible, locate the hall there. If this was found impractical, it was suggested that the two measures, to determine whether the Canfield property on the hill or the old city hall property on Main street be used, be placed on the ballot.

Dr. H. S. Mount in a plea to have the matter viewed from an economical standpoint emphasized the fact that the suggestion to have the compromise site adopted was made irrespective of the financial loss involved in the abandonment of the present structure, the leasing of which he pointed out would be a very difficult proceeding.

Cross Gives Opinion
Councilman Cross scored the recent McLoughlin park case as an attempt to hide "behind two women's skirts," and stated that the real motive behind the affair had leaked out, and that it was disclosed as an attempt (Continued on page four.)

JAPANESE SMUGGLERS WOUNDED BY SHERIFFS

ST. HELENS, Ore., April 17.—Caught red-handed in an attempt to smuggle whiskey ashore from the steamer Kaku Maru, two Japanese sailors engaged in a fierce hand-to-hand battle with three Columbia county deputy sheriffs at 9:30 o'clock this morning. Both of the smugglers were wounded.

FILING TIME ENDS FOR PRIMARY CANDIDATES

Al A. Price Only Democrat on List; Judge Campbell to be Unopposed for Bench Here.

At the primaries in May, local Democrats will have but one candidate to place for the race for the state legislature. Al Price has filed his candidacy for representative and is the only member of his party who will have his name on the ballot.

It is considered as probable that Matt Glover, who some years ago made the race, will conduct a campaign to have his name written in on the ballot.

The time for filing in the primaries closed yesterday. George L. Story, of Oregon City, did not file for Circuit Judge of the fifth district. This leaves J. U. Campbell, at present presiding on the bench, the only candidate for the office. He seeks the Republican nomination.

Other state offices, for which the filings were made when the books closed, are:

Representative, 16th District
Republican—Phillip Hammond Oregon City; George C. Randall, New Era; Robert Schuebel, Multnomah; Isom C. Bridges, Oregon City; M. J. Lee, Canby.

Democrat—Al A. Price, Oregon City.

State Senator—12th District
Republican—F. T. Tooez, Oregon City; William M. Stone, Oregon City; R. E. Cherrick, Barlow.

\$18,000 BONUS IS PAID BY LOCAL WOOLLEN MILL

Graduated Scale of Gratuity Payments Said Unique Plan Of Oregon City Industry.

A sum of \$18,000 was paid Saturday by the Oregon City Woollen Mills to their employees in the form of a bonus. Under the existing plan of the company every individual whose name appears on the payroll for six months is entitled to two and a half per cent of his total earnings.

This arrangement continues until the worker reaches a point where he has an added amount equal to 15 per cent of his receipts. The object of the company in offering this inducement is the establishment of a steady personnel at the plant.

An official of the company stated recently that approximately 80 per cent of the present force employed were classified in the 15 per cent category, this would indicate that the great majority of the present staff had three consecutive years or more service with the company.

The bonus scheme of the Oregon City Woollen mills is said to be the only one of its kind in the west.

OREGON CITY LEADS IN FIRE LOSS FOR MARCH

State Returns Show Damage In Busch Outbreak Biggest In Oregon for last Month.

SALEM, April 14.—Fifty-four fires in Oregon, outside of Portland, during March, resulted in losses aggregating \$275,580, according to estimates computed by State Fire Marshal A. C. Barber, upon reports filed with his office. More than one half the total is represented by the big garage fire at Oregon City, with a loss estimated at \$168,000. Thirty of the 54 fires were in dwellings, seven in barns, seven in mercantile and other business establishments.

WOMEN REFUSE TO ACT: NEW JURY PANEL DRAWN

A new panel of 14 jurors was drawn Saturday by the county clerk to augment the original list, from which a number of the women have declined. Eleven of the 17 women who were drawn in the first venire, have declined to serve. The remaining nine who have accepted service are: Maggie G. Friel, Cherryville; Arda L. Amrine, Hoff, Route 1; L. M. Fletcher, Molalla, Route 1; Louise Kamrath, Oregon City, Route 3; Augusta B. Haberlach, Clackamas, Route 1, and Dora B. Herring, Estacada.

The new list, to serve during the term which opens Monday, follows: Eliza M. Ingram, Oregon City, Route 3; Mollie E. Straight, 804—4th street, Oregon City; Edna Essen, Sandy; R. D. Wilson, 614 Water street, Oregon City; Clara E. Anthony, New Era; Olive A. Swallow, Gladstone; Paul Kinzer, Hubbard, Route 2; John R. Boyd, Canby, Route 1; Jessie M. Johnson, 312 Madison street, Oregon City; Gertie L. Everhart, Molalla; Maud M. Cameron, Aurora, Route 4; W. F. Hartnell, Milwaukie, Route 2; Nellie M. Alldredge, 216 Pierce street, Oregon City; R. L. Peake, Carver.

FIRECRACKERS START \$12,000 FIRE AT BORING

Half of Business District Burns; Town Is Threatened By Blaze; Bucket Brigade From Gresham Gives Aid.

LIVES OF CROWD IN THEATRE IN DANGER

Conflagration Under Control After Hours' Fight; Wind from West Helps in Battle.

BORING, April 13.—(Special)—Wiping out half of the business section here, endangering the lives of more than 50 people gathered in the local movie show, and threatening a large portion of the residential section, a fire, caused by firecrackers, did between \$10,000 and \$12,000 damage here at 9:15 o'clock this evening.

Men, women and children were gathered in the Boring theatre to-night when the fire started in the pool hall below. They were warned and all escaped before the flames found their way to the upper part of the structure.

All of the business houses on the east side of Broadway street were burned to the ground. Bucket brigades were only able to save the surrounding buildings, and were aided by a westerly wind which kept the flames from catching on the other side of the street.

The movie hall, the Van Dolin shoe shop, the barber shop, dance hall, and Boring Truck company garage in which two trucks were stored, were a total loss. Moran's home and the postoffice were saved, though the Moran house was damaged by water and the windows broken.

A call was sent to Gresham for the fire department, but the engine could not come due to the condition of the roads. Three cars of fire fighters however, were dispatched, and the bucket brigades were formed.

The movie and the pool hall were located in the Waller building and are both owned by M. E. Waller. His loss was said tonight to be about \$1,500. The fire was under control at 11 o'clock tonight.

DANCE HALL LICENSE IS CONDEMNED BY GRANGE

A resolution, condemning the granting of the Oak Grove dance hall license was passed at a meeting of the Palmyra grange, held Wednesday at the Parkplace grange. The resolution follows:

Whereas, H. Tregastis and M. L. Hubbard conducted a dancing pavilion at the Oak Grove beach in the year 1921, and

Whereas, said dancing pavilion was conducted in such a manner as to affect the morals of the people attending and discredited the community in which said dancing pavilion was conducted, and

Whereas, it was necessary to employ special officers to see that the law was enforced, and

Whereas, the said people in violation of their agreement, conducted the said dancing pavilion on Sunday, and

Whereas, a remonstrance was filed against the granting of another license for the year 1922, and approximately 90 per cent of the residents of said community were opposed to the granting of such license and protests were made by the residents of said community by petition and in person, now therefore,

Be it resolved, that we, the Pomona Grange of Clackamas County, Oregon, condemn the action of the commissioners for granting the said license against the protests of the citizens of the community and the County Judges.

COMPANY TO BE QUIZZED ON RAILROAD CROSSING

The top was torn from a truck owned by Edith Olsen of 254 North Twenty-first street, Portland, at 14th and Washington streets Wednesday night by the overhead crossing of the Southern Pacific. The owner escaped uninjured except for a slight scratch on the face.

Residents in the vicinity who heard the crash assisted him in loading the wrecked top onto the truck. There have been several accidents at this point caused by the low overhead clearance. The matter will be taken up with the city council and the Southern Pacific company in an effort to have changes made. Another matter that will be brought to the attention of the railroad company and the public service commission is the grade crossing between the St. Agnes baby home and Oregon City.

\$4,000 BLAZE AT BARCLAY SCHOOL HELD INCENDIARY

That the fire in the Barclay school early Sunday morning was of incendiary origin, is the theory held by local officials after a survey of the scene of the blaze which broke out in the building at Twelfth and Madison at 4 o'clock.

The damage is believed to amount to more than \$4,000. The reason for the belief that the blaze was the work of a fire bug is that the start was gained in the interior of a cloak room on the lower floor which was entirely empty. The blaze swept up through the ceiling, the second floor and out through the roof. There were, the authorities say, no possibilities of the blaze being due to defective wiring or anything of this nature, and it had been empty since school let out Friday.

The blaze was discovered by Frank Koenig, who had just returned with his wife from Portland, where they had attended a party. Mr. Koenig's attention was drawn towards the building by a light and he immediately turned in the alarm. About 100 people were attracted, many of the residents including some of the volunteer firemen not hearing the alarm, and had it not been for the prompt action of the fire department the entire building would have been destroyed, when arriving they found the flames had eaten through the walls into several of the rooms, and up through the roof. The woodwork of rooms on the south side of the building is badly charred.

The damage amounting to about \$4,000, is covered by insurance.

During the height of the fire Captain Gerald Warner in company with Joseph Beaulieu, hoseman, was overcome by smoke, and almost suffocated. He remained unconscious for about one and one-half hours, after being removed to the home of Mr. and Mrs. S. M. Cox on Twelfth and Madison streets, where Dr. Edward McLean was summoned and gave medical attention. Joseph Beaulieu also suffered from electric shock, when coming in contact with a live wire. He was also overcome with the dense smoke. Chief Prieb, Assistant Chief Ferson and Al Cox, hoseman, who were also fighting the fire in the attic, came to their rescue. Cox carrying the limp form of Captain Warner down a narrow ladder and out of the burning building. He was later revived.

The sprinkler system in the basement aided in keeping the fire from entering that part of the building, but only one of the sprinklers was working. The origin of the fire is under investigation. There had been no fire in the building since Friday, according to the janitor, George Gallman. Owing to the condition of the building, caused by fire and water, school has been dismissed until the building is gotten into condition, and it is probable that the classes in a number of grades will be resumed about Wednesday.

RAILROAD WILL IMPROVE CROSSING AT PARKPLACE

The condition of the crossing on the River road between Oregon City and Parkplace will be improved by the Southern Pacific company, according to word received by J. R. Stafford, engineer for Oregon City.

A communication from Mr. Stafford recently drew the attention of the railroad to the fact that the planking did not extend far enough to allow for the aprons. Cars which were forced to pass on the crossing, were compelled to get off the planks, and get caught in the tracks, often having to run down the ties in order to prevent turning turtle.

RIGHT TO CLOSE ROAD IS DENIED BY COURT

The Holcomb road where it crosses the O. P. Collier place is a public highway and cannot be stopped by a gate, according to the decision of Judge J. U. Campbell in the circuit court Monday. In the case of S. Stanger against Collier and Van Zant, his lessee, it was held that the thorofare, being dedicated, did not revert back to the owners of adjacent property when the farm changed hands. The place was recently purchased by Collier.

SAFE BLOWN; JANITOR BOUND; \$3000 STOLEN

PORTLAND, April 17.—The safe of the Panthea theater was blown and robbed of between \$3000 and \$3500 at 2:30 o'clock this morning. The yegmen have thus far escaped.

Sam Bagley, negro night janitor, lay bound and gagged in a dressing room off the stage of the theater for two hours before he was finally able to work himself loose and give the alarm.

The office and the safe were wrecked by the explosion of nitroglycerine. The amount stolen represents the Saturday night and Sunday receipts.

BODY OF VICTIM OF AUTO MURDER IS SAID IN RIVER

Corpse of Portland Musician Put In Hop Sack, Weighted With Rocks and Sunk, Boy Confesses to Police Official.

HECKER TELLS STORY OF FATAL INCIDENTS

Circumstantial Evidence Net Leads to Breakdown of Lad Who Faces Heavy Charges.

ALBANY, Ore., April 18.—Russell Hecker, confessed slayer of Frank Bowker, Portland musician led a party of Portland police and detectives late today to the place where he said the body of Bowker, weighed with stones and tied in a huge hop sack had been thrown into the muddy, swirling waters of the Calapoopa river, two miles west of Albany on the Albany-Corvallis highway.

Albany townsmen early tonight were still grappling with improvised hooks for the body of Bowker.

Complaint Filed
PORTLAND, April 18.—Russell Hecker was formally charged with first degree murder this morning in a complaint filed in municipal court by Deputy District Attorney John Mowry. City Detective Fred Maliet swore to the information.

The complaint comes after an all night investigation of the mysterious disappearance of Frank Bowker, a musician, who was last seen with Hecker.

A net of circumstantial evidence had been woven about the youth but as yet the body of Bowker has not been discovered.

OREGON CITY STUDENTS GUESTS AT CONFERENCE

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON, Eugene, April 14.—The conference for Student Body presidents and secretaries of the high schools of the state and the editors, managers and staff representatives of the high school papers opened today at Philip Paine, Quenton Cox and Bud Baxter, Dwight Hedges and Albert Grossenbacher representing the Oregon City high school.

While at the university Philip Paine, Quenton Cox and Bud Baxter are guests at the Alpha Tau Omega house, Dwight Hedges at the Phi Gamma Delta house and Peter Laurs and Albert Grossenbacher at Friendly hall. The Oregon City delegates will leave Eugene Sunday afternoon.

Over 175 students representing more than 21 high schools had registered at the university at the close of the first day of the conference.

Hal E. Hoss, managing editor of the Oregon City Enterprise, is also attending the conference.

Coal Exports Are Smaller than 1920

The exports of domestic bituminous coal from the United States during the year 1921 amounted to 20,652,738 long tons, valued at \$122,596,704 according to a report of the Fuel Division of the Department of Commerce. This was a decline of 40 per cent, as compared with the 1920 exports, which were 34,390,254 long tons, valued at \$304,273,241. These figures do not include bunker coal laden on vessels engaged in the foreign trade, which in 1920 aggregated 9,362,178 tons and in 1921 amounted to 7,547,518 tons.

The decrease in the 1921 trade was divided mainly between France, Netherlands, Sweden, Canada and Argentina. Of the total exports of soft coal, 12,489,550 tons or 61% went to Canada. The 1921 exports, while below those of 1920 were nevertheless 300,000 tons above the average of the past nine years. Exports to Canada were 500,000 below the nine year average and to other countries 1,006,000 tons above it.

Anthracite exports during 1921 were about 650,000 tons less than in 1920, the total was 4,176,221 long tons. Coke exports in 1921 declined 65 per cent from the 1920 figure, exports in 1921 being 278,888 tons as compared with 821,252 tons in 1920.

EX-AUSTRIAN CONSUL TO RETAIN NATURALIZATION

PORTLAND, April 17.—Joseph Woerndle, former Austrian consul here, will retain his American citizenship.

United States District Judge Bean this morning handed down a decision refusing to cancel Woerndle's naturalization papers.

FIRE DAMAGE IN BORING IS PLACED AT \$15,000

Loss from Blaze Found to be More than First Survey Showed; Figures are Given.

BORING, April 15.—Revised estimates of the damage done by the fire which swept half of the business section here Thursday night, place the loss at \$15,000. The original estimates were \$12,000.

Four buildings on the east side of the street were burned down.

S. E. Waller, owner of the building which housed the pool hall, a barber shop and confectionery store, was unable to save any of his equipment. He could not account for the origin of the fire.

Waller's loss was estimated \$4000, with insurance on the building itself.

S. N. Morgan, owner of the Boring theatre, placed his loss at \$5000, with nothing insured. His living quarters above the garage building of W. R. Pelford were also a total loss.

Equipment in a shoe shop occupied by S. T. Van Donelen was saved, but the building destroyed. A Peterson, proprietor of a studio above the shop, likewise saved his furniture.

The Boring Auto Truck company, operated by Shaver and Yeon, lost a truck and supplies valued at \$3000.

Ernest Glarner's loss consisted of a truck valued at the same amount. The home of William Morand was damaged, but a bucket brigade with reinforcements from Gresham, saved it from destruction. The impassable condition of the roads prevented the Gresham fire department from responding to an S. O. S. call.

MULTNOMAH REQUESTS DECISION ON LOOP ROAD

PORTLAND, April 14.—Efforts to revive Multnomah county's participation in the Mount Hood loop road featured today's opening session of the state highway commission, when Chairman R. A. Booth called upon Rufus C. Holman of the county commission to explain again definitely the county's policy.

The original agreement for the improvement of the road was made between Multnomah and Clackamas counties, and the state. Clackamas has already expended the major portion of its share on the work, but the Multnomah appropriation was held up by the state tax commission which claimed that they had no authority to contract an agreement against taxes yet unlevied.

Holman reiterated that the county had in good faith included the \$85,000 item for this year's installment of the loop road fund in the annual budget, which sum was stricken out as not of paramount necessity by the tax commission. He said the policy of the county board would be to include the item in its annual budget until the full amount of \$170,000 had been paid.

Booth asked if other county road funds might not be diverted to apply on the loop project and to ascertain if this can be done. Holman invited Booth to canvass the county road budget and work out something at the beginning of the end of the intensive state highway construction of the last few years will be in sight with the opening of bids today and Saturday on projects constituting the major part of this year's work. The projects will embrace approximately 295 miles of construction, together with a number of bridges. The aggregate cost is estimated at \$2,500,000.

VENUE CHANGE GIVEN; OVERLOADER FINED \$10

After applying for a change of venue from the local justice court, T. W. Sellwood was convicted Thursday in the Oak Grove court before Judge C. A. Lewis, on charges of overloading.

Sellwood was accused of overloading a truck 2400 pounds. He was fined \$10 and \$40 costs after the jury returned a verdict of guilty. J. Dean Butler was named as special prosecutor for the state.

7 KILLED, MANY INJURED BY IRVINGTON CYCLONE

CENTRALIA, Ill., April 17.—Seven are dead, four are reported missing and 18 injured, following a cyclone which practically wiped out Irvington, Ill., today, according to reports reaching here over badly crippled wires.

4 KILLED, MANY HURT IN KENTUCKY WIND STORM

LOUISVILLE, Ky., April 15.—Four lives were lost and many persons were injured yesterday in a rain, hail, wind and lightning storm which swept practically all parts of the state.

EQUALIZATION OF TAX BURDEN SAID NEED OF STATE

Judge L. E. Bean, Candidate for Governorship Speaks to Live Wires; Income Tax Is Advocated to Aid Problem.

CHURCH HEAD TELLS NEED FOR OPTIMISM

Industrial Conditions Are Held Psychological; No Need of Depression, Claim.

That the total debt of the state of Oregon equals one-third of its known wealth and that only 22 per cent of the population are taxpayers was a statement made by L. E. Bean, candidate for governor, at a meeting of the Live Wires in the commercial club rooms, Tuesday noon.

Mr. Bean pointed out that the total indebtedness of the state is at present 313 million dollars and the listed value of its resources in excess of one billion dollars. The inequality of the tax burden was illustrated by the speaker when he pointed to the fact that the output from the farms in the Willamette valley little more than exceeded the amount demanded by the state in the form of taxation. As a contrast to this Mr. Bean showed that a sum of one billion dollars was tied up in non-taxable bonds and securities, held by various individuals and corporations throughout Oregon.

Income Tax Favored
As a remedy for this condition, the candidate for governor suggested equalization of the burden by a form of income tax which would be graduated in such a manner that the collection would be made wherever the amount collected would offset the cost or expense of the levy. Declaring that the state had been deprived of some five million dollars in revenue since 1918, Mr. Bean showed that in 1896 a grant of land 29 miles in breadth and stretching clear across the state which was made to a certain railroad for the purpose of fostering construction had by an act of congress in 1916 been removed from the tax roll. Another instance of loss of revenue in the opinion of the speaker was exemplified in the setting aside of some 13 million acres of forest reserve and although not wishing to suggest that the conservation of our forests was not a highly commendable scheme yet at the same time the fact remained that this vast area was not contributing toward the maintenance of the many public institutions which were dependent on state appropriations.

Optimism Held Need
Eulogizing the spirit displayed by the business men both in Oregon City and elsewhere, Rev. Spence, pastor of the Presbyterian church at Vancouver, spoke on the benefits to be derived from a concerted spirit of optimism. It was, he maintained essential for the well being of the nation that an organized state of mind typifying expectant prosperity be universally adopted. Good or bad conditions of industrial life were largely psychosocial and to a great extent governed by mental attitudes he said. At the same time this could not be construed as the sole thing necessary to the production of better times declared the speaker, should, not lose sight of the fact that foreign markets were needed to absorb the surplus products and that the actions of the government controlled the future of the country.

Prior to the regular addresses a report was received by the main trunk from the committee in charge of the city hall site. The committee asked for definite instructions stating that the compromise was meeting with considerable opposition at the forthcoming house debate between the members on the architectural problems involved a resolution was passed that the compromise location be submitted to the city council.

The main trunk reminded the members that this was book week and that any donations that could be made particularly in the form of technical literature would be a distinct aid to the library and community at large.

An announcement was also made by Mr. Clay promising unlocked for attractions at the forthcoming house warming and stating that any members who had failed to receive cards could obtain same by communicating with the secretary.

TAX REDUCTION CLUBS PLAN WIDE DISCUSSION

A series of meetings over the county for the purpose of discussing the tax situation in an effort to clarify conditions and propound solutions, are planned by the Tax Reduction club of Clackamas county.

The definite program for the meetings has not yet been made out but it is expected that the series will be arranged in the representative communities.